GUEST COLUMN | VIKRAM SAMPATH



"SPJIMR EMPOWERED ME WITH AN ANALYTICAL MIND"

MUMBAI-BASED SPJIMR IS AMONG THE FEW INSTITUTES THAT INVEST TIME AND ENERGY TO MAKE THE CONCEPT OF BEING SENSITIVE TO SOCIETY A REGULAR PART OF THEIR PEDAGOGY

I **look back on my time at** the S.P. Jain Institute of Management and Research (SPJIMR) with a lot of gratitude. Those were some of the best days of my life, if I can borrow lines from the Bryan Adams song. I had just completed the five-year engineering course at the Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS), Pilani, and the SPJIMR was a completely new experience. That it was located in Mumbai made a significant difference.

Right from the word go, the pedagogy was different. Before we even joined, we were given a lot of pre-course work materials. The day we reached, there was a test to welcome us. It was quite obvious that we had to come prepared. There was no time to settle down. For those who came from science and engineering backgrounds, the pre-course materials had subjects such as economics, which we had never studied before. The students from the arts were not conversant with subjects such as mathematics and statistics. Students had to study the course materials by themselves and then appear for the test. While it seemed extremely excessive—a test on the first day—but so much thought was put into the exercise that it prepared us for the rigours of the next two years at the SPJIMR. However, the faculty were ready to do a little bit of hand-holding to create a level-playing field for students coming from diverse educational backgrounds.

I don't know how it is now, but during my time, the SPJIMR was the only institute offering specialisation (The IIMs offered only general management courses). I specialised in finance. Being in Mumbai was an advantage, as it is the financial capital of India. Most of the industry captains came as guest lecturers. Some of our courses were taken by them. There used to be CEO lecture series. Over time, these concepts, such as specialisation, have been adopted by other B-schools too.

The SPJIMR also pioneered another novel idea called the Assessment and Development of Managerial and Administrative Potential (ADMAP). The students were divided into groups that managed everything—admissions, placements, development of college infrastructure, formation of hostel committees, cultural committees. Each group had one faculty in-charge. ADMAP helped us get a hands-on training in management, administration, and crisis handling. The onus of running an institute of that scale was on the students. Of course, I was in a more benign committee—the cultural committee—which was about putting together events. But even in doing so, there had been so many crises that we could not anticipate initially. We

WHERE IS THE BEST VALUE FOR MONEY?

How different categories of B-schools fare in terms of return on the money spent as course fee

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE ROI
TOP 1-25	1.36
TOP 26-50	1.05
TOP 51-75	0.89
TOP 76-100	0.90

Note: ROI (return on investment) is calculated by dividing average domestic annual salary with fees for the entire course

GOVERNMENT VS PRIVATE

(Among top-100 B-schools)

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE ROI
GOVERNMENT	1.70
PRIVATE	0.90

CITY-WISE

(Among top-100 B-schools)

Mumbai business schools offer the best value for money

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE ROI
DELHI NCR	1.18
MUMBAI	1.36
BENGALURU	0.89